

Chapter 113-1: Revealing Herself

And that alluring and debauched person was actually Ning Fuyi?!

Chu Qingqiu stood there stunned and stepped forward two paces, almost walking right out of the pavilion. At this moment, footsteps came from behind her, interrupting her soul-lost movements.

She barely managed to support herself against the wall, but couldn't move her gaze away from the far side of the Alchemy Cauldron Manor.

The woman was no longer leaning toward the beauty's ear, but had raised her head to say something to the beauty. The mask blocked her lip movements, but judging from the beauty's smiling expression, it was undoubtedly jesting.

"Divine Venerable, you..." Zhou Yantan, who had re-entered the room, said carefully. However, seeing Chu Qingqiu's expression, she didn't dare say more.

The figure before her was truly illuminated by the lights, merging with the Milky Way as if a breeze could transform her into stars and embed her in the sky alongside the galaxy.

Orange candlelight flowed across her eyes, leaving patches of red hue, her jaw clenched and lips tightly pressed.

Chu Qingqiu had never felt herself so out of control. Resentful anger surged from the bottom of her heart. These three months she had deliberately tried to forget everything about herself as Su Mo, but now seeing her intimate with others, all those memories came flooding back, unable to be smoothed away.

She knew Su Mo was her, yet she still couldn't avoid the jealousy in her heart toward that other self, let alone witnessing other people being so intimate with her.

She had been born with the command of heartlessness—only through heartlessness could she remain unrestrained, achieve the great way, and protect the smooth flow of all living beings.

But that Chu Qingqiu who could once control all desires had been pulled down to the mortal realm, and after returning, she was no longer the former Chu Qingqiu.

Now she couldn't control her hatred, couldn't control her desires, and couldn't control her longing.

Those thoughts pressed upon her constantly, making her mind chaotic and nearly driving her to madness.

But what could she do now? Go find her, humble herself and apologize, saying she actually loved her? Say she had simply been afraid to speak before and thus put on that cold and distant appearance that caused her pain?

Could she do such a thing?

She suddenly felt somewhat tired, retreating slightly. Zhou Yantan quickly stepped forward to support her but was avoided by her raised hand.

"You may go. I'm truly fine." She spoke gently, then softly called: "Bai Lin¹."

The white tiger, having shrunk its form, appeared behind her, carrying a wooden chair in its mouth and setting it down, then staring at Chu Qingqiu with large eyes like glazed orbs as she sat down.

Then those eyes turned toward the opposite side and immediately lifted high, its large nose flaring as its blood-filled mouth let out a pre-attack roar.

It seemed to understand the reason for its master's emotional change. Its hind legs pushed off as it prepared to pounce through the air, but Chu Qingqiu grabbed its tail with her hand and gave a low rebuke, causing it to wilt and whimper as it lay at Chu Qingqiu's feet.

"Bai Lin, this isn't her fault. Don't go." Chu Qingqiu said.

Ning Fuyi had deliberately exposed the prayer bead earlier and now covered it again, using the mask's concealment to look toward the opposite side. Colorful light smoke rose from the high platform, drifting out of the circular pavilions and obscuring the bright moonlight.

That figure had already sat down, becoming blurry and unclear.

She didn't know whether Chu Qingqiu had recognized her, and if she had, what her reaction would be.

At least for now, there seemed to be no reaction.

Ning Fuyi suppressed the resentment in her heart and directed her gaze to the neighboring pavilion that had remained quiet and silent, with several layers of gauze curtains blocking it, unwilling to face the world.

Ning Fuyi smiled slightly, raising her hand to have the beauty sit beside her, then called over two graceful women in flowing skirts to help her peel lychees.

These lychees sent from Guangling were truly sweet, several times sweeter than those she'd eaten before.

"Hey, why haven't they made a move yet?" Nine Infant was getting tired of acting, lazily leaning against Ning Fuyi. "My mouth is sore from smiling."

"Don't be anxious. This is their game—they'll be more anxious than us." Ning Fuyi took a peeled lychee and brought it to Nine Infant's mouth, but Nine Infant slapped her hand away in disgust, grabbed the lychee, and tossed it into her own mouth.

Now she was throwing a tantrum. Ning Fuyi pressed her lips together—Du Baishuang was better at this kind of work.

As she was thinking this, a melody on the high platform had ended. The swaying Jiangnan women gracefully walked down, but no one came up for a long time, and the venue fell into chaos.

Everyone found it strange, looking around and whispering to each other.

"Isn't it supposed to be the Ghost Sight Sect's turn next? Where are they?" Tao Tao looked around with her braids standing up.

"Did you hear any sounds?" Feng Ge rose slightly, following the sound. "It seems like someone is crying."

"What's going on?" From the Flying Flower Sect's neighboring area, Hua Feiwu, sitting with his legs crossed high, drawled, making the Alchemy Cauldron Manor even more chaotic and the crying sounds unclear.

Liu Wenzhu squinted and listened for a while, then suddenly grabbed Rong Jin and looked up, exclaiming: "Look quickly!"

So everyone looked up in unison and were shocked to see two flashing figures flying from somewhere—two immortal soldiers wearing armor, with someone clamped in their hands.

That person wore white clothes with white silk wrapped around her shoulders, floating with her movements. There was a gap between her upper shirt and lower skirt, revealing a slender waist wrapped with silver thin chains.

The immortal soldiers released their grip from mid-air, and the woman screamed as she fell, rolling half a circle on the high platform before struggling to support herself, her eyes full of terror.

Tears flowed down her pure and beautiful face like white flowers, truly pitiful and stirring compassion in most who witnessed this scene.

In the distant pavilion still indulging in sensual pleasures, the beauty suddenly leaned toward Ning Fuyi's ear in what appeared to be flirtation but actually said: "There, they caught her. Why didn't you stop her initially? Now there's more trouble."

"Du Baishuang isn't stupid. She knew I would use this opportunity to reveal myself. Her capture doesn't affect my plan, and knowing I wouldn't not save her, she acted deliberately to show her loyalty and make me trust her." Ning Fuyi said indifferently.

She took another lychee and ate it, her voice muffled: "Using this incident to teach her a lesson and make her have fewer schemes isn't necessarily bad."

"Moreover, Du Baishuang is a rare natural treasure among the Spirit Folk, of extraordinary significance to the Spirit Race. The Spirit Folk have long been oppressed by the immortal realm. Her appearing publicly as one of my people— isn't this also a way to win over the Spirit Folk?"

Hearing this, Nine Infant couldn't help but move away from Ning Fuyi, her narrow eyes glancing sideways: "How did you become so calculating now? So frightening."

"Life forces it upon me." Ning Fuyi smiled.

1. **Bai Lin:** Literally means "White Lin" - referring to the white tiger companion of Chu Qingqiu. "Lin" (麟) can refer to the mythical qilin or be used as a general term for powerful mythical beasts.